

A CYBER-AWARENESS CARD GAME

HUMAN FIREWALL

Everyday cyber risks, real decisions, no jargon. A discussion-driven game for the whole team.

40 Scenario Cards · 7 Role Cards · 12 Event Cards · 4 Decision Cards · Score Tracker · Facilitator Guide

Built for HR · Finance · Sales · Execs · Admin · New Hires · Remote Workers

What this game is

Human Firewall turns cyber-security awareness into a 30–45 minute table conversation. A scenario lands — a suspicious email, an urgent call, a found USB stick — and the team decides how to react. The facilitator reveals what happens, the score moves, and everyone learns through consequences instead of slides.

The one rule that teaches everything: when something is urgent, unexpected and asks for money, data or access — slow down and verify it through a channel you already trust.

Who it's for

Designed for non-technical staff: HR, finance, sales, executives, administrative teams, brand-new hires and remote workers. No security background is needed to play or to facilitate.

What players practise

- **Spotting** everyday attacks: phishing, fake invoices, QR scams, MFA fatigue, deepfake calls, smishing and more.
- **Deciding** calmly under pressure using four simple choices.
- **Habits** that scale: verify out of band, report early, never share codes, badge everyone in.
- **Communication**: who to check with, and how to raise a concern without fear.

Components & setup

In the kit

- **40 Scenario cards** — the heart of the game. Most are attacks, but some are legitimate requests and some are deliberately ambiguous, so players must read each situation rather than reflex-report.
- **7 Role cards** — each player takes a workplace role with its own attack profile and one special ability.
- **12 Event cards** — channel-linked pressure (a wave hits one channel, so wrong answers there cost double) plus rewards the facilitator can drop in.
- **4 Decision cards** — TRUST, VERIFY, REPORT, ESCALATE (print one set per player).
- **Score Tracker** — four team meters plus a 10-incident log.
- **Outcomes Key** — facilitator-only answers for every scenario (keep this hidden from players).

Setup (about 5 minutes)

- 1 Pick a facilitator.** They run the round, keep the Outcomes Key, and move the score. They don't 'win' — they coach.
- 2 Deal a role** to each player (2–6 players is ideal; larger groups split into teams).
- 3 Give every player a set of Decision cards** so they can show their choice.
- 4 Set the meters** on the Score Tracker to their starting values, and shuffle the Scenario and Event decks separately.

How a round works

- 1 Draw a Scenario.** The facilitator reads it aloud. It usually targets a specific role — that player leads, but everyone joins in.
- 2 Discuss (1–2 min).** Is it real? How would you check? Who should approve? This conversation is where the learning happens.
- 3 Decide.** The lead player (or the team) plays one Decision card face-up.
- 4 Reveal the consequence.** The facilitator reads the matching outcome from the Outcomes Key and adjusts the meters.
- 5 Share the learning point** from the key, then move to the next incident. Drop in an Event card whenever you want to raise the pressure.

The four meters

All four are tracked for the whole team — you win or lose together.

Reputation

70

Public & customer trust. 0 = ruined.

Funds

100k

Company money. 0 = bankrupt.

Security Score

60

How hardened you are. 0 = wide open.

Stress

30

Team pressure — **lower is better**. 100 = burnout.

Win (Cooperative): survive 20 incidents with Reputation ≥ 50 , Funds > 0 , Security ≥ 40 and Stress ≤ 80 .

Instant loss if any meter hits its danger point: Funds 0 (bankrupt), Reputation 0 (ruined), Security 0 (fully breached) or Stress 100 (the team burns out).

Final rating: 80–100 Security = “Human Firewall ★★★” · 60–79 = “Security-Aware ★★” · 40–59 = “Getting There ★”.

Two ways to play

Cooperative Mode (default — best for workshops)

Everyone protects the company together against the deck. Discuss openly and aim for the best collective call on each incident.

Speed Round (great for energy)

Teams have 60 seconds per scenario to discuss and commit a Decision — no outcome is revealed until the timer ends. Rewards instinct and exposes the gut-reaction “just click it” habit.

Facilitator tips

- **Let the wrong answer happen.** A bad outcome with a calm debrief teaches more than steering players to the ‘right’ card.
- **Ask “how would you verify?”** every round until it becomes a reflex.
- **Make reporting safe.** Reward REPORT generously and never mock a near-miss — in real life, fear of blame is what hides breaches.
- **Tie it back to your tools.** Name your real report-phishing button, your IT number and your payment-approval process during the debrief.
- **Keep it to ~60 minutes.** Twenty incidents plus a short debrief makes a full session.

Adapting to your industry

Swap a few scenario themes to make it hit home. Same mechanics, familiar context:

Sector	Tailor scenarios toward...
Hospitals & Clinics	Fake patient-record requests, ‘doctor’ calls for urgent prescriptions, vendor invoice fraud.
Banks & Finance	Wire-transfer fraud, fake regulator emails, ‘account verification’ phishing.
Schools & Universities	Parent/teacher phishing, fake fee-payment links, student-data requests.
Retail	POS malware, fake supplier invoices, gift-card scams, QR menu/payment scams.
Shipping & Logistics	Fake customs emails, courier SMS scams, redirected-payment invoice fraud.
Law & Professional Services	Client-impersonation, confidential-document requests, deepfake partner calls.

Later expansions can add a mobile app, Microsoft Teams integration, AI-generated practice phishing, and company-customised scenario packs.

Outcomes Key — Facilitator only, keep hidden

For each scenario, read the outcome that matches the Decision the team played, apply the meter changes, then share the learning point. Funds changes are shown in 'k' (thousands).

PASSWORDS

Scenario #01

The Breach Notice

ATTACK

TRUST

You assume it's fine and change nothing. Attackers reuse the password and break into your email.

Sec -30

Funds -15k

Stress +20

VERIFY

You confirm the alert is really from IT, then realise the risk. Good caution.

Sec +5

REPORT

You tell security, who force a reset before anyone gets in.

Sec +10

Stress -5

ESCALATE

You ask IT to reset everywhere and switch on MFA and a password manager.

Sec +15

Funds -5k

Stress -5

Best move: ESCALATE / REPORT

Learning point: One leaked password unlocks everything if you reuse it — use unique passwords and a password manager.

MFA FATIGUE

Scenario #02

Approve? Approve? Approve?

ATTACK

TRUST

You tap Approve just to make it stop. The attacker is now inside your account.

Sec -30

Rep -5

Stress +20

VERIFY

You check the location and time, see it isn't you, and deny it.

Sec +5

REPORT

You deny it and alert security. They lock the account and block the attacker.

Sec +15

Stress -5

ESCALATE

You call IT, who reset your credentials immediately.

Sec +10

Best move: REPORT

Learning point: Never approve a login prompt you didn't start — repeated prompts are an attack. Deny and report.

QR SCAM
Scan to Pay

Scenario #03

ATTACK

TRUST

You scan and enter your card. The details are stolen on a fake page.

Sec -15

Funds -20k

Stress +15

VERIFY

You use the meter's official app instead of the sticker. Safe.

Sec +5

REPORT

You tell facilities/security. The fake sticker is removed and others are protected.

Sec +10

Stress -5

ESCALATE

Facilities investigate where the sticker came from.

Sec +5

Best move: REPORT

Learning point: A QR code hides where it really goes — don't scan random ones in public; use the official app or site.

INVOICE FRAUD
The Bank Details Changed

Scenario #04

ATTACK

TRUST

You pay the new account. The money goes straight to a fraudster.

Rep -15

Funds -35k

Stress +20

VERIFY

You call the supplier on the number you already have. The change is fake.

Sec +5

REPORT

You flag it to security and finance. The fraud is caught and others are warned.

Sec +10

Stress -5

ESCALATE

Dual approval catches the mismatch before payment.

Stress +5

Best move: VERIFY (call a known number)

Learning point: Always confirm changed bank details by calling a number you already trust — never the one on the invoice.

The Found Drive

ATTACK

TRUST

You plug it in. Malware runs automatically and spreads onto the network.

Sec -30

Funds -15k

Stress +20

VERIFY

There's no safe way to 'check' it by plugging in — you treat it as suspicious.

Sec +5

REPORT

You hand it to IT, who examine it safely in isolation.

Sec +10

Stress -5

ESCALATE

IT investigate a possible 'USB drop' targeting the office.

Sec +10

Best move: REPORT**Learning point:** 'USB drop' attacks bait your curiosity — never plug in a drive you found. Hand it to IT.

The CEO's Voice

ATTACK

TRUST

You make the transfer. The voice was AI-cloned; the funds are gone.

Rep -15

Funds -35k

Stress +30

VERIFY

You call the CEO back on a known number (or use your code word). It's fake.

Sec +5

REPORT

You flag the attempt to security. The team is warned about voice-clone fraud.

Sec +10

Stress -5

ESCALATE

You require the normal payment-approval process, which stops it.

Stress +5

Best move: VERIFY (call back on a trusted number)**Learning point:** AI can clone a voice. Urgency + secrecy + money is the scam pattern — always verify on a known channel.

The Helpful Post

ATTACK**TRUST**

The post stays up. Attackers harvest the details for a targeted phishing attack.

Sec -15

Rep -5

Stress +5

VERIFY

You check exactly what's visible in the photo first.

Sec +5

REPORT

You quietly flag it; the post is taken down and friendly guidance is given.

Sec +10

Stress -5

ESCALATE

You ask a manager to clarify the social-media policy for everyone.

Sec +5

Best move: REPORT (and coach them)

Learning point: Badges, screens and 'behind the scenes' posts leak details attackers use. Think before you post.

Your Files Are Locked

ATTACK**TRUST**

You pay the ransom. There's no guarantee of recovery — and you're now a known payer.

Sec -15

Funds -35k

Stress +30

VERIFY

You don't negotiate alone — you get help before doing anything.

no change

REPORT

You disconnect the device and call IT at once. The spread is contained; backups restore the files.

Sec +10

Stress -5

ESCALATE

Incident response and leadership coordinate a clean recovery — no payment.

Sec +15

Funds -5k

Best move: REPORT (disconnect & call IT)

Learning point: Don't pay and don't panic — isolate the device and call IT. Good backups beat ransoms.

Send Me Payroll

ATTACK

TRUST

You send the file. The account was hijacked — employee data is leaked.

Sec -20

Rep -20

Stress +20

VERIFY

You reach your manager another way and learn their account was compromised.

Sec +10

REPORT

You flag the account to IT, who secure it before more damage is done.

Sec +15

Stress -5

ESCALATE

Manager and security are looped in and the account is locked.

Sec +10

Best move: VERIFY, then REPORT

Learning point: Even a trusted account can be hijacked — verify unusual data requests through another channel.

A Message from the Boss

ATTACK

TRUST

You reply and help, and get drawn into a gift-card / transfer scam.

Rep -5

Funds -15k

Stress +15

VERIFY

You confirm with the CEO's real contact — the account is fake.

Sec +5

REPORT

You report the impersonation; the account is taken down and staff are warned.

Sec +10

Stress -5

ESCALATE

Comms and security alert all staff to the fake account.

Sec +10

Best move: REPORT

Learning point: Impersonation accounts copy names and photos — verify identity before acting on 'confidential' asks.

IT Support Calling

ATTACK

TRUST

You install the 'fix' and grant access. The caller now controls your PC.

Sec -30

Stress +20

VERIFY

You hang up and call IT on the number you know. There's no such ticket.

Sec +5

REPORT

You report the call so security can warn others.

Sec +10

Stress -5

ESCALATE

IT investigate the spoofed support call.

Sec +5

Best move: VERIFY (call IT back yourself)

Learning point: Real IT won't cold-call you for remote access — hang up and call the number you already know.

There's an App for That

ATTACK

TRUST

You upload the data. The client list is now in the hands of an unknown third party.

Sec -15

Rep -15

Stress +5

VERIFY

You check with IT whether the tool is approved — it isn't, so you find a safe option.

Sec +5

REPORT

You ask IT to vet it; they approve a safe alternative.

Sec +10

ESCALATE

IT review and provide a sanctioned tool.

Sec +10

Best move: VERIFY / ESCALATE with IT

Learning point: Free 'helpful' tools can harvest your data — check with IT before uploading any company information.

Enable Content to View

ATTACK

TRUST

You enable content. Hidden macro malware runs on your machine.

Sec -30

Stress +20

VERIFY

You weren't expecting it, so you don't enable anything and check the sender.

Sec +5

REPORT

You report it as phishing; the sender is blocked.

Sec +10

Stress -5

ESCALATE

IT examine the file in a safe environment.

Sec +5

Best move: REPORT (don't enable content)

Learning point: 'Enable content' on an unexpected document can run hidden malware — when in doubt, report it.

Left on the Train

ATTACK

TRUST

You wait and hope it turns up. The data is exposed if the wrong person finds it.

Sec -15

Rep -15

Stress +20

VERIFY

You retrace your steps and check lost property — but every minute counts.

Stress +5

REPORT

You tell IT immediately; they remote-lock and wipe it before anyone can access it.

Sec +10

Stress -5

ESCALATE

IT and your manager handle containment and any disclosure.

Sec +10

Best move: REPORT (fast, so IT can wipe it)

Learning point: Report lost devices immediately — a quick remote lock or wipe turns a disaster into a non-event.

From the New Auditor

ATTACK

TRUST

You send the list. It's used to build a convincing mass-phishing campaign.

Sec -20

Rep -5

Stress +15

VERIFY

You confirm with your own finance/audit contact — there is no such auditor.

Sec +10

REPORT

You report the call; staff are warned of the pretext.

Sec +10

Stress -5

ESCALATE

A manager verifies whether any audit is actually engaged.

Sec +5

Best move: VERIFY (through your own contact)

Learning point: 'Officials' who pressure you for staff data are a classic pretext — verify through a contact you already trust.

The Monthly Invoice

LEGITIMATE

TRUST

You pay it through the normal process. The supplier is paid on time and the relationship stays healthy.

Rep +5

VERIFY

You quickly match it against the purchase order before paying. Prudent — costs a moment.

Stress +5

REPORT

You flag it as fraud. Security investigates, finds nothing, and a real supplier is left waiting.

Rep -5

Stress +15

ESCALATE

You bump a routine payment up the chain. Fine, just slower than it needed to be.

Stress +5

Best move: TRUST (pay via the normal process)

Learning point: Not everything is an attack. A known supplier, normal channel, unchanged details and a matching PO are signs it's genuine — and paying on time matters too.

Patch Tonight

LEGITIMATE

TRUST	You let it run. Your machine stays patched and protected. Sec +10
VERIFY	You confirm it really came from the IT channel. Quick and sensible. no change
REPORT	You report it as phishing. Security spends time confirming their own genuine notice. Stress +15
ESCALATE	You escalate a routine notice. Unnecessary, but harmless. Stress +5

Best move: TRUST (no links, no credentials, official channel)

Learning point: Real IT messages come through official channels and never ask for passwords or urgent clicks. Spotting a genuine notice avoids alarm fatigue.

The First Morning

LEGITIMATE

TRUST	Payroll is set up correctly and securely. A smooth start. Sec +5
VERIFY	The new hire double-checks they're in the real HR system. Good habit. no change
REPORT	They report their own legitimate onboarding. Awkward, and it stalls their setup. Stress +15
ESCALATE	Unnecessary for a normal in-person setup. Stress +5

Best move: TRUST (in person, official system, no links)

Learning point: Compare this with the fake 'confirm your bank details' email: official system, in person, no links. Context separates real from fake.

VERIFIED CUSTOMER
Their Own Account

Scenario #19

LEGITIMATE

TRUST	You provide it through the portal. Good service, happy customer. Rep +5
VERIFY	Their identity is already confirmed by the portal, but a quick check doesn't hurt. Stress +5
REPORT	You treat a verified customer as a threat. Security finds nothing and the customer is frustrated. Rep -5 Stress +5
ESCALATE	You pass a routine, verified request up the line. Slower service than needed. Stress +5

Best move: TRUST (identity verified through the official portal)

Learning point: Security shouldn't block legitimate service. Verified identity through an official channel means you can help with confidence.

ROUTINE REQUEST
The Weekly Report

Scenario #20

LEGITIMATE

TRUST	You send it. Normal request, normal channel — work moves along. no change
VERIFY	You insist on verifying a routine, non-sensitive request. It's safe, but it slows things and signals distrust. Rep -5 Stress +5
REPORT	You report your own manager's normal request. Confusing for everyone. Rep -5 Stress +15
ESCALATE	You escalate a routine request — unnecessary friction. Stress +5

Best move: TRUST (normal channel, normal request, nothing sensitive)

Learning point: Constant suspicion of normal requests grinds work to a halt. Save verification for the red flags: urgency, secrecy, sensitive data, or an unusual channel.

UNUSUAL INVOICE

The Urgent Invoice

Scenario #21

JUDGMENT CALL

TRUST You pay it as-is. The figure was padded from a compromised supplier mailbox — partly avoidable.

Funds -20k

Stress +15

VERIFY One call to the supplier on a known number clears it up before any money moves.

Sec +5

REPORT You escalate to security. A bit heavy for one odd detail, but no harm.

Stress +5

ESCALATE You route it for a second approval — reasonable for an unusual amount.

Sec +5

Best move: VERIFY — one quick call resolves the doubt

Learning point: When something is mostly normal but one detail is off (amount, tone, urgency), a 30-second check beats both blindly paying and crying fraud.

POSSIBLE LURE

Recruiter in Your Inbox

Scenario #22

JUDGMENT CALL

TRUST You send a full CV with personal details to an unverified stranger. Possibly fine, possibly harvested.

Sec -5

Stress +5

VERIFY You check the recruiter's profile and the company before sharing anything. Sensible.

no change

REPORT You report it. If it was genuine, you may have flagged a real recruiter — minor noise.

Stress +5

ESCALATE Not really an escalation matter.

Stress +5

Best move: VERIFY (check the profile and company first)

Learning point: Not malicious by default, not safe by default. Verify the source before handing over personal information.

Sign In Again

JUDGMENT CALL

TRUST You type your password straight into the popup. If it was fake, it's now stolen.

Sec -15

Stress +15

VERIFY You close the popup and sign in by opening the app yourself. Safe either way.

Sec +5

REPORT You report it. If real, a little noise; no harm done.

Stress +5

ESCALATE You ask IT — fine, if a touch slow.

Stress +5

Best move: VERIFY (sign in through the app yourself, not the popup)

Learning point: Re-auth prompts are often real — but only ever enter credentials somewhere you navigated to yourself.

Did You Send This?

JUDGMENT CALL

TRUST You click it. Their account had been hijacked and the link was malicious — partly avoidable.

Sec -15

Stress +15

VERIFY A quick 'did you send this?' confirms it before you click. Two seconds well spent.

Sec +5

REPORT You report it without asking. If genuine, a small false alarm.

Stress +5

ESCALATE You loop in IT — a bit much before a simple check.

Stress +5

Best move: VERIFY (a quick 'did you send this?')

Learning point: Even real colleagues get hijacked. A two-second check before clicking an unexpected link costs nothing.

The Journalist Calls

LEGITIMATE

TRUST You comment on the company's behalf without authority — your words become the story.

Rep -20

Stress +15

VERIFY You can't verify a breach yourself, and that isn't the point.

Stress +5

REPORT You file an IT ticket — wrong channel. This is a comms and leadership matter.

Stress +5

ESCALATE You take a message and pass it straight to management / comms. Exactly right.

Rep +5

Best move: ESCALATE (to management / comms)

Learning point: Press, legal and regulator questions go straight to management — never improvise on the company's behalf, and never just sit on them.

A Request for Records

LEGITIMATE

TRUST Even though it's genuine, you release customer data on your own authority — a serious overstep.

Sec -15

Rep -15

Stress +15

VERIFY Confirming it's real is wise — but once it is, you still must escalate, not act alone.

Stress +5

REPORT This isn't a phishing report; it needs an authority decision.

Stress +5

ESCALATE You route it to management / legal / your data-protection lead for sign-off. Correct.

Sec +5

Best move: ESCALATE (for the right sign-off)

Learning point: Even a legitimate request for sensitive data needs proper authorisation. Confirm it's real, then escalate — don't release data solo.

Working From Home

LEGITIMATE

TRUST	You decide it's none of your business — and quietly condone the risk. Sec -15
VERIFY	There's nothing to verify; the behaviour is plain to see. Stress +5
REPORT	You open a formal security incident on a careless but well-meaning colleague — heavier than it needs to be. Stress +5
ESCALATE	You raise it calmly with your manager / security, so it's handled and the person gets support. Sec +10

Best move: ESCALATE (raise it through the right channel)

Learning point: Insider mistakes are a people problem, not a phishing report. Raise them through your manager or security so they're handled constructively.

The Access Request

LEGITIMATE

TRUST	You hand over broad admin access with no review — a real exposure, however well-meant. Sec -20 Stress +15
VERIFY	Confirming identity is fine, but the real question is how much access is appropriate. Stress +5
REPORT	Nothing here to report — it isn't a threat, it's an authorisation call. Stress +5
ESCALATE	You route it to the system owner for a least-privilege review and approval. Exactly how big grants should work. Sec +10

Best move: ESCALATE (for least-privilege approval)

Learning point: Genuine-looking, high-impact requests still need the right approval. Escalate big access grants for review rather than granting — or blocking — them yourself.

A Quiet Demand

ATTACK

TRUST You engage and arrange payment alone — funding a criminal with no guarantee of anything.

Funds -30k

Stress +20

VERIFY There's no safe way to 'check' an extortion demand yourself.

Stress +5

REPORT Logging it helps, but a threat like this needs leadership and incident response, not just a ticket.

Stress +5

ESCALATE You take it straight to leadership and incident response. The right people respond as a team.

Sec +5

Best move: ESCALATE (to leadership / incident response)

Learning point: A credible threat against the company goes to leadership and incident response fast — don't pay, don't negotiate, and don't sit on it alone.

The Replacement Laptop

LEGITIMATE

TRUST You collect it from the IT desk. Sorted — it was your own ticket.

Sec +5

VERIFY You double-check with IT, who confirm what you already knew. Minor delay.

Stress +5

REPORT You report a reply to your own ticket as phishing. Security closes it as a false alarm.

Stress +5

ESCALATE You escalate a routine collection. Unnecessary.

Stress +5

Best move: TRUST (it references your own ticket and asks for nothing)

Learning point: A message that follows up on something you started, and asks for no credentials, is a strong sign it's genuine.

The Project Invite

LEGITIMATE

TRUST You accept and join. A normal invite for real work.

no change

VERIFY You quiz your teammate about a routine invite. Safe, but it slows you both down.

Stress +5

REPORT You report a colleague's normal meeting invite. Confusing for everyone.

Rep -5 Stress +5

ESCALATE You escalate a calendar invite. Overkill.

Stress +5

Best move: TRUST (known colleague, real project, normal channel)

Learning point: Reserve suspicion for unexpected links from unexpected people — routine invites from known colleagues are just work.

The Approved Expense

LEGITIMATE

TRUST You note it and carry on. Correct — it's your own claim, through the right system.

no change

VERIFY You check with finance about your own approved claim. Harmless, slightly wasteful.

Stress +5

REPORT You report finance's genuine approval as fraud. They're unimpressed.

Stress +5

ESCALATE You escalate a routine approval. No need.

Stress +5

Best move: TRUST (your own claim, internal system)

Learning point: Confirmations of things you initiated, through the systems you already use, are normal — not every money email is fraud.

The Matching Bank Details

LEGITIMATE

TRUST	You proceed using the on-file details. Correct — nothing changed, no fraud signal. no change
VERIFY	You call to confirm details that already match the file. Prudent, but it delays a clean payment. Stress +5
REPORT	You raise fraud where nothing changed. Security finds nothing; the supplier waits. Rep -5 Stress +5
ESCALATE	You escalate a routine, unchanged payment. Slower than it needed to be. Stress +5

Best move: TRUST (details match the file; nothing changed)

Learning point: The fraud signal is a *change* of details under pressure. Matching, on-file details with no change request are normal — don't freeze every payment.

The Training Reminder

LEGITIMATE

TRUST	You complete the training via the portal you know. Done. Sec +5
VERIFY	You confirm the link — it's the internal portal. Fine. no change
REPORT	You report your own security team's reminder. They sigh. Stress +5
ESCALATE	You escalate a training nudge. Unnecessary. Stress +5

Best move: TRUST (internal portal you already use)

Learning point: Genuine internal comms use internal systems you recognise — learn to tell them from look-alikes rather than flagging everything.

The Shared Document

ATTACK**TRUST**

You sign in to 'view' it. Your credentials are captured on a look-alike page.

Sec -30**Stress +20****VERIFY**

You hover the link and check with the colleague — they never shared it.

Sec +5**REPORT**

You report it; the look-alike sender is blocked before others fall for it.

Sec +10**Stress -5****ESCALATE**

You loop in a manager — fine, though reporting is the faster path.

Stress +5

Best move: REPORT (off-platform link from an outside domain)

Learning point: Fake 'shared a document' notices copy the real ones. Check the sender domain and where the link goes — when it's external, report it.

The Half-Familiar Invoice

ATTACK**TRUST**

You pay it. The money goes to a fraudster trading on a real supplier's name.

Rep -15**Funds -35k****Stress +20****VERIFY**

You check the PO and find no matching order. Good catch.

Sec +5**REPORT**

You report the fraud pattern so colleagues hit by the same scam are warned.

Sec +10**Stress -5****ESCALATE**

You raise it with finance leadership — reasonable for suspected fraud.

Sec +5

Best move: REPORT (no matching PO — warn others)

Learning point: Fake invoices latch onto real supplier names; a missing or wrong PO is the tell. Report it so the campaign is flagged for everyone.

The Partner's Question

JUDGMENT CALL

TRUST	You share the deal details. Confidential terms leak before anything's authorised. Sec -15 Rep -20 Stress +20
VERIFY	You confirm the person is real — but the real question is whether you're allowed to disclose at all. Stress +5
REPORT	A phishing ticket doesn't fit — this is a disclosure-authority question. Stress +5
ESCALATE	You route it to the deal owner / management to decide what can be shared. Right call. Sec +5

Best move: ESCALATE (disclosure isn't yours to authorise)

Learning point: Confidential business information needs the owner's decision — escalate, even when the person asking is genuine.

The Quiet Word

JUDGMENT CALL

TRUST	You agree to keep it secret and do nothing. Possible fraud goes unaddressed — and now you're sitting on it. Sec -15 Rep -5 Stress +15
VERIFY	You start digging into the manager yourself — not your role, and risky. Stress +15
REPORT	A security ticket isn't the right channel for suspected fraud. Stress +5
ESCALATE	You raise it through the proper escalation / whistleblowing channel, in confidence. Sec +5

Best move: ESCALATE (through the whistleblowing channel)

Learning point: Suspected wrongdoing goes through the proper confidential channel — don't investigate it yourself, and don't bury it.

The Angry Refund

JUDGMENT CALL

TRUST	You approve the large refund on the spot — well beyond your authority. Funds -20k Stress +15
VERIFY	You confirm the order details — useful, but the sticking point is the amount, not the facts. Stress +5
REPORT	This isn't a security report; it's an authority and service call. Stress +5
ESCALATE	You bring in a manager who can actually authorise that amount. Right move. Rep +5

Best move: ESCALATE (it's above your limit)

Learning point: Requests beyond your authority — especially with pressure or threats attached — go to someone who can actually decide.

The Ghost Account

JUDGMENT CALL

TRUST	You leave the account live. A departed user's access lingers as a standing risk. Sec -20 Stress +15
VERIFY	You confirm the manager really asked — but the issue is the policy exception, not who asked. Stress +5
REPORT	It's not a phishing report; it's an offboarding decision. Stress +5
ESCALATE	You route it to security / HR for a proper data-handover and offboarding decision. Sec +10

Best move: ESCALATE (offboarding is a security/HR call)

Learning point: Offboarding exceptions are a security and HR decision — escalate rather than quietly keeping ghost accounts alive.

Scenario Cards (1 of the deck)

Print, then cut along the borders. Colour bands show the attack channel. Players see only the front — outcomes live in the Outcomes Key.

DEVICES & TECH#01 The Breach Notice TARGETS: ANYONE IT warns that a website where you used your work password has been breached. The same password also protects your work email. What do you do? Choose a Decision card.	DEVICES & TECH#02 Approve? Approve? Approve? TARGETS: ANYONE Your phone buzzes with login-approval requests over and over at 11pm — sign-ins you never started. One more pops up. What do you do? Choose a Decision card.	ON THE GO#03 Scan to Pay TARGETS: ANYONE A sticker on the office parking meter reads “Scan to pay / update card details.” The QR code opens a payment page. What do you do? Choose a Decision card.
MONEY & PAYMENTS#04 The Bank Details Changed TARGETS: FINANCE OFFICER A known supplier emails a normal-looking invoice, with a note: “Please note our bank account has changed — pay the new account below.” What do you do? Choose a Decision card.	DEVICES & TECH#05 The Found Drive TARGETS: ANYONE You find a USB stick in the car park labelled “Payroll 2025 — Confidential.” Curiosity says plug it in. What do you do? Choose a Decision card.	PHONE & VOICE#06 The CEO’s Voice TARGETS: FINANCE OFFICER / ADMIN A call comes in. It sounds exactly like the CEO: “I’m in a meeting — move €40,000 to this account right now, and keep it quiet.” What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

SOCIAL & ONLINE

#07

The Helpful Post

TARGETS: INTERN / NEW HIRE

An intern proudly posts a first-day photo — their screen, their badge, and “Can’t believe how easy our new vendor portal login is!”

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

DEVICES & TECH

#08

Your Files Are Locked

TARGETS: ANYONE

A red full-screen message appears: “All your files are encrypted. Pay \$2,000 in crypto within 48 hours or lose everything.” A colleague says “just pay it!”

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#09

Send Me Payroll

TARGETS: HR MANAGER / FINANCE

A Microsoft Teams message from your manager’s account: “Hey, can you send me the payroll spreadsheet urgently? I’m boarding a flight.”

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

SOCIAL & ONLINE

#10

A Message from the Boss

TARGETS: ANYONE

A brand-new account using the CEO’s name and photo messages staff: “I need your mobile number for a quick confidential task.”

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

PHONE & VOICE

#11

IT Support Calling

TARGETS: ANYONE

A caller says: “This is IT — we’ve found a virus on your PC. I’ll walk you through installing a fix; just grant me remote access.”

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

DEVICES & TECH

#12

There’s an App for That

TARGETS: SALESPERSON / ANYONE

To work faster, a teammate suggests uploading the full client list to a free online tool they found to ‘clean it up.’

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#13

Enable Content to View

TARGETS: ANYONE

An attachment, “Invoice.docx,” opens to a banner: “Protected view — Enable Content to see this document.”

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

ON THE GO

#14

Left on the Train

TARGETS: SALESPERSON

You realise your work laptop — logged in and full of client data — was left on the train.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

PHONE & VOICE

#15

From the New Auditor

TARGETS: HR MANAGER / FINANCE

A polite caller claims to be a new external auditor and asks you to email a list of all staff names, emails and job titles ‘for the audit.’

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

MONEY & PAYMENTS

#16

The Monthly Invoice

TARGETS: FINANCE OFFICER

A regular monthly invoice lands in the accounts inbox from a supplier you've used for years. Same bank details as always, the usual amount, and it matches an existing purchase order.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

DEVICES & TECH

#17

Patch Tonight

TARGETS: ANYONE

A message in the official IT channel says a security update will install automatically tonight. No action needed, no links, and it never asks for your password.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

PHYSICAL & IN-PERSON

#18

The First Morning

TARGETS: INTERN / NEW HIRE / HR

On the new hire's first morning, HR sits with them and sets up payroll directly inside the official HR system — in person, no emails, no external links.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#19

Their Own Account

TARGETS: SALESPERSON / ADMIN

A customer, logged in and identity-verified through your official support portal, asks for a copy of their own account information.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#20

The Weekly Report

TARGETS: ANYONE

Your manager, in your usual work chat thread, asks you to send over a non-sensitive document the two of you share every week.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

MONEY & PAYMENTS

#21

The Urgent Invoice

TARGETS: FINANCE OFFICER

An invoice from a known supplier arrives — bank details unchanged, but the amount is noticeably higher than usual and the tone is pushier and more urgent than their normal emails.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

SOCIAL & ONLINE

#22

Recruiter in Your Inbox

TARGETS: ANYONE

A recruiter messages you with a plausible-looking role and asks you to send your CV and contact details. It might be a real opportunity — or a way to harvest your information.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

DEVICES & TECH

#23

Sign In Again

TARGETS: ANYONE

Right after a genuine software update, an app asks you to sign in again. It could be a normal re-authentication — or a fake prompt placed to catch your password.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#24

Did You Send This?

TARGETS: ANYONE

A coworker drops a document link in chat. You weren't expecting it, but it's plausibly work-related and they often share files.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

PHONE & VOICE

#25

The Journalist Calls

TARGETS: RECEPTIONIST / ADMIN / EXECUTIVE

A journalist phones and asks you to confirm whether the company suffered a data breach last week. You're not certain, and it isn't your place to speak for the company.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#26

A Request for Records

TARGETS: HR MANAGER / FINANCE

A request arrives — confirmed genuine through proper channels — from a regulator asking for a set of customer records. It's real, but releasing customer data is a big, high-stakes step.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

DEVICES & TECH

#27

Working From Home

TARGETS: ANYONE / IT

You notice a teammate routinely emailing unencrypted customer spreadsheets to their personal Gmail so they can work from home. They're not malicious — just careless.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

DEVICES & TECH

#28

The Access Request

TARGETS: IT / DEVELOPER

A new manager asks — politely, through the proper ticket system — for full admin access to a sensitive system 'to do their job.' The request looks legitimate and follows process, but it's a big privilege to grant.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

MONEY & PAYMENTS

#29

A Quiet Demand

TARGETS: ANYONE / EXECUTIVE

An email addressed to you personally threatens to leak company data unless you arrange a payment quietly, today. It feels aimed and credible.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

DEVICES & TECH

#30

The Replacement Laptop

TARGETS: ANYONE

IT emails — referencing the support ticket you opened last week — to say your replacement laptop is ready. Bring your badge to the IT desk to collect it. No links, no password requested.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#31

The Project Invite

TARGETS: ANYONE

A meeting invite arrives from a teammate you work with daily, for the project you're both on, at a normal time, from their usual address, with the standard Teams link.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

MONEY & PAYMENTS

#32

The Approved Expense

TARGETS: ANYONE

Finance emails from the internal finance address, through the expense system you always use, to say your travel claim is approved and will be paid on Friday.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

MONEY & PAYMENTS

#33

The Matching Bank Details

TARGETS: FINANCE OFFICER

A supplier emails to confirm the bank details for an upcoming payment. You compare them: they exactly match what's already on file. Nothing is being changed.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#34

The Training Reminder

TARGETS: ANYONE

An internal email from your security team reminds everyone to finish annual training by month-end. It links to the internal training portal on your company domain that you've used before.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#35

The Shared Document

TARGETS: ANYONE

An email looks like a 'document shared with you' notice — 'Q3 Budget' from a name close to a colleague's. But the sharing address is an outside domain and the link leaves your company's systems.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

MONEY & PAYMENTS

#36

The Half-Familiar Invoice

TARGETS: FINANCE OFFICER

An invoice references a real supplier and a real project — but you never ordered this, and the PO number matches no order on file. It's a fake riding on a genuine relationship.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

EMAIL & MESSAGES

#37

The Partner's Question

TARGETS: EXECUTIVE / ADMIN

Someone from a partner company asks — plausibly and politely — for confidential details of the upcoming deal 'so we can prepare our side.' You're not sure what's been agreed or who's cleared to share it.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

PHYSICAL & IN-PERSON

#38

The Quiet Word

TARGETS: ANYONE

A colleague quietly tells you they think a manager is fudging the numbers, and asks you to keep it strictly between you two.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

MONEY & PAYMENTS

#39

The Angry Refund

TARGETS: SALESPERSON / ADMIN

A long-standing customer furiously demands a refund far above your approval limit and threatens to 'post about it everywhere' if you don't act now. Their grievance may well be genuine.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

DEVICES & TECH

#40

The Ghost Account

TARGETS: IT / DEVELOPER

A manager asks you (in IT) to keep a just-departed employee's login active 'for a little while' so the team can reach their files — skipping the normal offboarding.

What do you do? Choose a Decision card.

Role Cards

Deal one per player. Each role has its own attack profile and a once-per-game special ability.

ROLE

Receptionist / Front Desk

The first point of contact for every visitor, call and delivery.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Tailgating, suspicious visitors, phone scams.

Special: Gatekeeper — once per game, auto-resolve any physical/visitor scenario as VERIFY (prevented).

ROLE

HR Manager

Holds the personal data of everyone in the company.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Fake onboarding, data requests, payroll phishing.

Special: Records Lock — once per game, cancel one Reputation loss from a data-leak outcome.

ROLE

Finance Officer

Controls payments — the prize attackers want most.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Invoice fraud, business-email compromise, deepfake transfer calls.

Special: Dual Control — once per game, force VERIFY on a money scenario (no Funds lost that round).

ROLE

CEO / Executive

High authority and a public profile — often the person attackers impersonate.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Impersonation and deepfakes (as the faked person), targeted phishing.

Special: Set the Tone — once per game, reduce the team's Stress by 10.

ROLE

Intern / New Hire

Eager to help and still learning what's normal.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Pressure tactics, onboarding scams, oversharing online.

Special: Beginner's Question — once per game, ask the facilitator one yes/no question before deciding.

ROLE

IT / Developer

Keeps the systems running and is trusted with access.

OFTEN TARGETED BY
Vishing ('IT support'), malicious files, shadow IT.

Special: Patch It — once per game, turn one REPORT into a guaranteed 'attack prevented.'

ROLE

Salesperson

Always on the move, with lots of external contact and devices.

OFTEN TARGETED BY

Public Wi-Fi, lost devices, QR scams.

Special: Road Warrior — once per game, ignore one Stress penalty.

Event Cards

Each event is tied to a scenario channel (its colour): when a wave hits, wrong answers on that channel cost double for the next few incidents. The plain blue cards are rewards and reliefs.

EMAIL & MESSAGES Phishing Wave A phishing wave floods inboxes. For the next 3 incidents, a wrong answer on an Email & Messages card costs double.	MONEY & PAYMENTS Finance Under Fire Fraudsters are hammering finance. For the next 3 incidents, a wrong answer on a Money & Payments card costs double.	PHONE & VOICE Scam-Call Run A run of convincing scam calls. For the next 3 incidents, a wrong answer on a Phone & Voice card costs double.
PHYSICAL & IN-PERSON Visitor Day The building is full of strangers. For the next 3 incidents, a wrong answer on a Physical card costs double.	DEVICES & TECH Patch Backlog Systems are behind on updates. For the next 3 incidents, a wrong answer on a Devices & Tech card costs double.	SOCIAL & ONLINE In the Spotlight The brand is trending and watched. For the next 3 incidents, a wrong answer on a Social & Online card costs double.
ON THE GO Conference Season Half the team is on the road. For the next 3 incidents, a wrong answer on an On-the-Go card costs double.	EVENT Awareness Training Done Reward: Security +10 and Stress -5.	EVENT Audit Week For the next 3 incidents, a correct answer earns +5 extra Security.
EVENT Budget Approved Reward: Funds +15.	EVENT A Calm Stretch Reward: Stress -10.	EVENT Board Review Leadership is under scrutiny: Reputation -10.

Decision Cards

Print one set per player. These are the only four choices anyone ever needs.

DECISION

TRUST

Do exactly what the message or caller asks. Comply with the request.

DECISION

VERIFY

Independently confirm through a second, trusted channel before acting.

DECISION

REPORT

Flag it to IT / Security (report-phishing button, ticket, or security@).

DECISION

ESCALATE

Hand the decision to a manager or security lead for approval.

Score Tracker

Mark each meter's starting box, then move it as outcomes are revealed. The team survives by keeping all four in safe territory across 20 incidents.

Reputation

Public & customer trust. Lose at 0. Win-line: keep ≥ 50 .

Start at 70

05101520253035404550556065707580859095100

Funds (in thousands)

Company money. Bankrupt at 0. Win-line: keep > 0 .

Start at 100

05101520253035404550556065707580859095100

Security Score

How hardened you are. Fully breached at 0. Win-line: keep ≥ 40 .

Start at 60

05101520253035404550556065707580859095100

Stress (lower is better)

Team pressure. Burnout at 100. Win-line: keep ≤ 80 .

Start at 30

05101520253035404550556065707580859095100

Incident log

#	Decision	Outcome / Δ meters
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		

#	Decision	Outcome / Δ meters
11		
12		
13		
14		
15		
16		
17		
18		
19		
20		